PRACTICE EXAM 05 / EXAM SET 01

Domain 5: Administrative Assisting

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

> **SCENARIO** A clinic requires a 30-minute appointment for a new pediatric patient. A qualified interpreter must attend the entire visit. The provider has openings from 9:00 to 9:15 a.m., 10:00 to 10:30 a.m., 10:30 to 11:00 a.m., and 11:00 to 11:30 a.m. The interpreter is available only from 10:00 to 10:30 a.m.

Which appointment should the medical assistant schedule?

A. 9:00 to 9:15 a.m.
B. 10:00 to 10:30 a.m.
C. 10:30 to 11:00 a.m.
D. 11:00 to 11:30 a.m.

Q02 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

> **SCENARIO** At check-in, a patient presents a new insurance card and says that coverage through a former employer ended last month. The practice-management system still lists the former plan as active. No eligibility check has been completed for today.

Which action best establishes the information needed for billing this visit?

A. Keep the former plan because the system labels it active.
B. Use the new card as proof that all services today are covered.
C. Enter both plans as active primary coverage for the visit.
D. Verify the new plan for the service date and update the account with the confirmed information.

Q03 | Coding Billing and Payments

Which pairing correctly identifies the code sets used for diagnoses and for procedures or services on outpatient medical claims?

A. ICD-10-CM for diagnoses; CPT/HCPCS for procedures or services.
B. CPT/HCPCS for diagnoses; ICD-10-CM for procedures or services.
C. ICD-10-PCS for diagnoses; CPT/HCPCS for procedures or services.
D. ICD-10-CM for diagnoses; ICD-10-PCS for routine office procedures.

Q04 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

> **SCENARIO** An assistant finds an outside consultation report indexed in the wrong electronic chart. The two patients have the same first and last names but different dates of birth and medical record numbers. Office policy requires staff to report indexing errors to the records coordinator, who uses a correction workflow that preserves the audit trail.

What should the assistant do?

A. Change the report date of birth to match the chart where it appears.
B. Upload a second copy into the other chart and leave the first copy in place.
C. Confirm the report identifiers and notify the records coordinator for correction through the designated workflow.
D. Delete the report and ask the specialist to create a replacement report.

Q05 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

> **SCENARIO** An established patient calls for a routine appointment but reports new dizziness that began this morning. The clinic telephone protocol directs scheduling staff to connect callers reporting new dizziness to the clinical nurse immediately. The nurse is available to take the call.

Which action follows the stated workflow?

A. Book the next routine opening and add dizziness to the appointment note.
B. Connect the caller to the clinical nurse now and document the handoff.
C. Ask the caller to try a home remedy before choosing an appointment.
D. Decide whether the dizziness is severe enough to require a same-day visit.

Q06 | Coding Billing and Payments

> **SCENARIO** An in-network covered service has a $240 allowed amount. The plan applies the patient's remaining $60 deductible first, then charges 20% coinsurance on the rest. There is no copayment, no other charge, and no out-of-pocket maximum adjustment. The patient already paid $30 toward this service. For this exercise, these amounts are final.

What additional amount remains for the patient to pay?

A. $36
B. $96
C. $108
D. $66

Q07 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO A clinic has 14 usable packs of examination-table paper and no outstanding order. It uses two packs per clinic day. An order placed now will arrive after five clinic days of use, before the next clinic day begins. Office policy sets the reorder point at expected use during delivery time plus four safety-stock packs.

Which inventory action follows the policy?

A. Wait three clinic days because the current stock covers a full week.
B. Wait until four packs remain because those packs represent the reorder point.
C. Place an order now because the current stock equals the 14-pack reorder point.
D. Place an order after five clinic days because deliveries take five days.

Q08 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO A patient has a nonurgent specialist visit scheduled next week. The plan requires both a primary care referral and a separate authorization for this visit. The signed referral is in the chart, but the payer portal shows no authorization request. Office policy assigns authorization submission and tracking to the referral coordinator.

Which action should the medical assistant take?

A. Mark the authorization approved because the primary care referral is signed.
B. Send the referral and required documentation to the coordinator and track the authorization status before the visit.
C. Change the referral diagnosis to one that is more likely to receive approval.
D. Tell the patient that the missing authorization means the plan has denied the visit.

Q09 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO An older adult misses an ordered follow-up visit. The scheduling policy requires staff to record the missed visit, contact the patient through the approved reminder system to offer rescheduling, and send a task to the clinical team when no replacement appointment is arranged. A call reaches voicemail, and no new appointment is scheduled.

Which documentation and follow-up are appropriate?

A. Record that the follow-up is complete because a reminder was sent.
B. Remove the visit from the schedule and wait for the patient to call.
C. Record that the patient declined care because the call was unanswered.
D. Record the missed visit and contact attempt, then route the unresolved follow-up task to the clinical team.

Q10 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO An uninsured patient asks about help paying for a scheduled visit. The practice has a financial assistance program with a standard application. Only the financial counselor may determine eligibility or approve payment arrangements, and the counselor is available.

Which response is within the medical assistant's administrative role?

A. Promise a fee waiver based on the patient's description of income.
B. Provide the program application and connect the patient with the financial counselor.
C. Tell the patient to enroll in the program without completing an application.
D. Assign a payment plan and ask the counselor to approve it afterward.

Q11 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO A technician services an examination-room scale and leaves a report documenting satisfactory operation. The report lists the service date, equipment serial number, work performed, technician, and next service date. Office policy requires those details in the equipment-service log before the scale returns to use. The scale's log has not yet been updated.

Which action completes the required office record?

A. Enter only the next service date on the room calendar.
B. File the technician's invoice with purchasing records without updating the log.
C. Match the report to the scale, enter the required service details in its log, and retain the report under office policy.
D. Copy the previous service entry and change only the date.

Q12 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO For one completed visit, an explanation of benefits lists $80 in final patient responsibility. The ledger shows that the patient already paid $25 toward that same visit and that the payment was posted correctly. There are no other balances, pending claims, or adjustments. A draft patient statement still shows $80 due.

How should the assistant reconcile the draft statement?

A. Apply the posted $25 payment to the $80 responsibility and show $55 remaining due.
B. Send the $80 statement because the explanation of benefits sets a new charge.
C. Refund the $25 payment and mark the visit paid in full.
D. Add the $25 payment to the $80 responsibility and show $105 due.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Practice Exam 05 | Domain 5: Administrative Assisting | 12 scored questions

01 B	02 D	03 A	04 C	05 B	06 D
07 C	08 B	09 D	10 B	11 C	12 A

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: B

10:00 to 10:30 a.m.

The 10:00 to 10:30 a.m. opening provides the required 30 minutes with both the provider and interpreter available. The shorter opening cannot accommodate the visit, and the later openings do not match interpreter availability.

Q02 | Correct answer: D

Verify the new plan for the service date and update the account with the confirmed information.

The assistant should verify current eligibility for the date of service and update the account with confirmed plan information. A card or an old active flag does not establish current benefits. Any remaining discrepancy should be resolved through the office verification process.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

ICD-10-CM for diagnoses; CPT/HCPCS for procedures or services.

ICD-10-CM describes diagnoses, and CPT/HCPCS identifies procedures, services, and applicable items or supplies. ICD-10-PCS is used for inpatient hospital procedure coding rather than routine physician-office procedure claims. Selection of a code must be supported by the encounter documentation.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

Confirm the report identifiers and notify the records coordinator for correction through the designated workflow.

The identifiers establish that the report was indexed to the wrong patient, and the stated policy specifies how to correct it. The assistant should initiate that process without altering the clinical report. Simply adding another copy leaves inaccurate information in the original chart.

Q05 | Correct answer: B

Connect the caller to the clinical nurse now and document the handoff.

The supplied protocol calls for an immediate clinical handoff, so the assistant should connect the caller to the available nurse and document that action. Choosing the urgency independently would exceed the scheduling role. Routine booking alone would bypass the required clinical review.

Q06 | Correct answer: D

$66

After the $60 deductible, $180 remains; 20% of $180 is $36. Total patient responsibility is $60 + $36 = $96. Subtracting the $30 already paid leaves $66 due; $96 would ignore the posted payment.

Q07 | Correct answer: C

Place an order now because the current stock equals the 14-pack reorder point.

Expected use during delivery is 2 packs/day x 5 days = 10 packs. Adding the four-pack safety stock gives a reorder point of 14 packs, so an order is due now. Waiting until only the safety stock remains would fail to account for supplies needed during delivery.

Q08 | Correct answer: B

Send the referral and required documentation to the coordinator and track the authorization status before the visit.

The stem specifies two separate requirements, and only the referral has been completed. Routing the documentation to the designated coordinator and tracking the request addresses the missing authorization. A request that has not been submitted is not a denial, and the assistant must not change a diagnosis to obtain payment.

Q09 | Correct answer: D

Record the missed visit and contact attempt, then route the unresolved follow-up task to the clinical team.

The record should accurately show both the missed visit and the contact attempt, with escalation as the stated policy requires. Reaching voicemail does not establish refusal or complete the follow-up. The clinical team can then review the unresolved follow-up need within its role.

Q10 | Correct answer: B

Provide the program application and connect the patient with the financial counselor.

The assistant can provide the established application and direct the patient to the staff member authorized to review eligibility and payment arrangements. This gives access to the office process without making an unsupported financial promise. Approval remains with the counselor under the stated policy.

Q11 | Correct answer: C

Match the report to the scale, enter the required service details in its log, and retain the report under office policy.

The service report supplies the information required by the stated policy. Matching the serial number ensures that the entry belongs to the correct scale, and recording the actual service details supports future maintenance tracking. An invoice or calendar reminder alone does not complete this log.

Q12 | Correct answer: A

Apply the posted $25 payment to the $80 responsibility and show $55 remaining due.

The remaining balance is $80 - $25 = $55. An explanation of benefits describes claim processing and patient responsibility; it is not a separate bill and may not reflect payments already made to the office. The statement must account for the correctly posted payment.

End of Practice Exam